

Intel Core X-series

Intel totally pulled one over AMD today as they unveiled the new Core X-Series Processors (Code named - Basin Falls) with the flagship processor having a massive 18-cores and 36-threads, that too for a lucrative price of \$1,999. This new processor series will stand right alongside the existing lineup from Intel and will use the new LGA 2066 pin socket which will be present on X299 motherboards. The Core X-Series will ship with the latest iteration of Intel Turbo Boost Max Technology 3.0. Essentially, Intel Turbo Boost Max Technology 3.0 improves single and dual-core performance in the X-series processors by clocking the very best cores to a much higher clock speed. As of now, this seems to be limited to the two best cores on the CPU die. Intel claims that the new Core-X Series will offer 10 percent faster multi-threaded performance and 15 percent faster single-threaded performance as compared to the previous generation.

As is with the Extreme platform under Intel's hierarchy, the X299 platform will feature quad-channel memory which works out in favour of multi-threaded applications. Another improvement is that of the smart-cache hierarchy. These new processors will have a slightly different distribution i.e. the shared cache memory will be reduced in favour of a greater



private-local cache by enlarging the Mid-Level Cache (MLC) and the shared Lower-Level Cache is being retained but since core count is greater, the amount of memory that each core gets is reduced. However, the shared LLC is now non-inclusive so that works out better in the end of the day. The top SKUs in the lineup boast of up to 44 PCIe lanes to play around with, so motherboards will now have a lot more interconnectivity ports that can run simultaneously rather than being multiplexed.

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